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MINISTRY OF AGRICULTURE

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Ref. No 06/ህዝ 6/1/703

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Date 17/08/2026

To: The Equity and Merit Scholarships Committee, The University of Manchester

Re: Reference for Lydia Fikire — Application for MSc Management and Information Systems: Change and Development

Dear Committee Members,

It is with great enthusiasm that I recommend Lydia Fikire for the MSc Management and Information Systems: Change and Development Programme at The University of Manchester.

In my capacity as the Director of the Strategic Affairs Executive Office at the Ministry of Agriculture, I worked closely with Lydia during the development and national rollout of our Planning & Performance Management System (PPMS). This was a critical digital transformation initiative designed to replace legacy manual processes, enabling state ministry offices to automatically generate annual targets, align performance indicators, and submit finalized reports directly to the Parliament of Ethiopia.

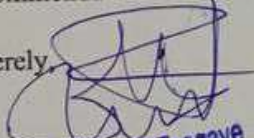
As an executive overseeing our result frameworks and strategic alignments, I relied heavily on Lydia's unique dual-capability. She was not only technically proficient in building the architecture of the system but demonstrated a rare, sophisticated understanding of institutional dynamics. Before writing a single line of code, Lydia conducted thorough socio-technical assessments to understand the daily realities and bottlenecks of our state ministry offices. She recognized that a digital system would only succeed if it reflected the complex administrative realities of the civil servants using it.

Furthermore, Lydia personally spearheaded the change management and capacity-building phase of this rollout. She trained over 50 ministry officials and affiliates across ministry. Transitioning a massive public institution from paper to digital requires immense patience and the ability to navigate bureaucratic resistance; Lydia achieved this by translating complex technical workflows into accessible, user-centric training.

Lydia possesses the exact temperament, analytical rigor, and resilience required to excel at the postgraduate level in the UK. She perfectly embodies the professional profile Ethiopia desperately needs right now: a technologist who deeply understands the organizational and human challenges of public sector reform.

I have no doubt that the advanced framework she will acquire through your program will equip her to return to Ethiopia and lead even larger e-government and digital infrastructure projects. She has my highest recommendation for the Equity and Merit Scholarship.

Yours sincerely,


Salim Tsegaye
Strategic Affairs Executive Officer



Salim Tsegaye

Strategic Affairs Executive Officer, Ministry of Agriculture

Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

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Addis Ababa, Ethiopia

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ADDIS ABABA UNIVERSITY

Date: 8/17/2026

Dear Committee Members,

I am pleased to write in strong support of Lydia Fikire Shirga's application to the MSc Management and Information Systems: Change and Development programme at The University of Manchester.

I taught Lydia Management of Information Systems during her Bachelor of Science in Information Systems at Addis Ababa University, where she graduated in 2024 with a cumulative average of 3.75 out of 4.00 and the distinction of "Very Great Distinction," placing her among the strongest students in her cohort. She was dedicated and hardworking, consistently engaged thoughtfully with course material, and frequently took on a representative role among her peers, whether in class discussions or in liaising between students and faculty.

What distinguished Lydia most was her genuine interest in how information systems function not merely as technical artifacts, but as tools embedded within organizations and their management structures. She approached coursework with a maturity that went beyond completing assignments, often asking questions that connected theory to real institutional challenges. This curiosity extended beyond the classroom: with my guidance, she founded a "Tech for Social Science Students" initiative, personally delivering computer literacy training to social science students from rural areas with little or no prior access to computers. The initiative reached over 1,000 students, equipping them with basic typing skills and proficiency in MS Word, PowerPoint, and other essential computer applications. As a direct result, certified students were able to attend their online classes, complete online tests, and independently prepare their own assignments using a computer — skills that had previously been out of reach for many of them. This was entirely Lydia's own initiative, carried through with genuine commitment and a clear sense of responsibility, and it reflects exactly the institutionally-minded, socially conscious thinking that management and information systems work ultimately requires.

This combination of academic strength, discipline, and a demonstrated commitment to using her skills for others gives me strong confidence in Lydia's ability to succeed at postgraduate level and to make meaningful use of this qualification in service of broader development goals. I recommend her application without reservation.

Please do not hesitate to contact me should you require any further information.

Yours sincerely,

Dr. Temtim Assefa
Department of Information Systems
Addis Ababa University
temtim.assefa@aau.edu.et | +251 911408837



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ADDIS ABABA UNIVERSITY

የአዲስ አበባ ዩኒቨርሲቲ ጉባዔ ሚኒስትሮች ምክር ቤት ደንብ ቁጥር
፳፻፴፯/፪ሺ፲፮ በተሰጠው ስልጣን መሰረት

The Senate of Addis Ababa University by virtue of the powers vested in it by the
Council of Ministers Regulation No. 537/2023 hereby grants to:

Lydia Fikire Shirga
THE DEGREE OF

የሳይንስ ባችለር ዲግሪ
በኢንፎርሜሽን ሲስተምስ (እጅግ በከፍተኛ
ማዕረግ)
ከሙሉ ክብር ጥቅሙና ግዴታዎቹ ጋር
ለ ሊዲያ ፍቅሬ ሽርጋ
ሰጥቷል።

Bachelor of Science
in Information Systems (With Very
Great Distinction)

ለዚህም ምስክር ይሆን ዘንድ በዲፕሎማው ላይ የዩኒቨርሲቲውን
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ሁለት ሺህ አስራ ስድስት ዓመቱ ምሕረት ተሰጠ።

with all honours, privileges and obligations pertaining thereto and in
witness thereof has authorized the issuance of this diploma duly signed
and sealed. Issued in Addis Ababa on this Fourth day of the month of July in
the year Two Thousand Twenty-Four.

የዩኒቨርሲቲው ፕሬዝዳንት
President of the University

የዩኒቨርሲቲ ሬጀስትራር
University Registrar

S/ No 141725

OFFICE OF REGISTRAR
1176 Addis Ababa, Ethiopia
College College of Natural and Computational Sciences

Addis Ababa University
STUDENT ACADEMIC RECORD
Medium of Instruction : English

Degree Awarded: BSc on July 4, 2024
School of Information Science

College College of Natural and Computational Sciences					Admission Classification: Regular				
Full Name : LYDIA FIKIRE SHIRGA					Date of Birth : 2002 G.C				
ID : UGR/0373/13					Sex : F				
Course No	Course Title	ECTS	Grade	Gr. Point	Course No	Course Title	ECTS	Grade	Gr. Point
	Admitted To Natural Science Freshman Program(Regular) 2020/21 Semester 1				InSy 2041	Fundamentals of Database Systems	5	A	20
						Semester Average: 4.00	32		128
						Cumulative Average: 3.84	95		365.25
Math 1011	Mathematics for Natural Sciences	5	A	20		2021/22 Semester 2			
LoCT 1011	Critical Thinking	5	A	20	Stat 2161	Introductory statistics	5	A	20
FLEn 1011	Communicative English Language Skills I **	5	B+	17.5	Econ1011	Economics	5	B	15
SpSc 1011	Physical Fitness	5	PASS	84	INSY2033	Introduction to Information Storage and Retrieval	5	A-	18.75
GeES 1011	Geography of Ethiopia and the Horn	5	B+	17.5	INSY2041	Data Structure and Algorithms	5	A+	20
PHY 1011	General Physics	5	B	15	INSY2032	Advanced Database Systems	5	A	20
Psyc 1011	General Psychology	5	B+	17.5	INSY2042	Object Oriented programming	5	A	20
	Semester Average: 3.58	30		107.5		Semester Average: 3.79	30		113.75
	Cumulative Average: 3.58	30		107.5		Cumulative Average: 3.83	125		479
	Transferred To Bachelor of Science in Information Systems (Regular) 2020/21 Semester 2					2022/23 Semester 1			
MGMT101	Entrepreneurship	5	A-	18.75	INSY2051	Computer Architecture & Operating Systems *	5	A	20
FLEn 1012	Communicative English Language Skill II	5	A	20	INSY3081	Introduction to Internet Programming	5	A+	20
Anth1012	Social Anthropology	4	A+	16	INSY3071	Introduction to Systems & Networks	5	A	20
MCIE 1012	Moral and Civic Education	4	A-	15	INSY3062	Fundamentals of System Analysis and Design	5	A-	18.75
EmTe1012	Introduction to Emerging Technology	5	A+	20	INSY3061	Research Methods in Information Systems	5	A	20
ECEg 1052	Computer programming	5	A	20	INSY2043	Event driven Programming	5	A	20
Math 1041	Applied Mathematics I	5	A	20		Semester Average: 3.96	30		118.75
	Semester Average: 3.93	33		129.75		Cumulative Average: 3.86	155		597.75
	Cumulative Average: 3.77	63		237.25		2022/23 Semester 2			
MgMt 206	Introduction to Management	5	A+	20	INSY3084	E-Commerce	5	A	20
AcFn1031	Principles of Accounting I	5	A+	20	INSY3073	Information System Security	5	A	20
	Foundations of Information Systems and society	7	A+	28	INSY3082	Advanced Internet Programming	5	A	20
InSy2013	Advanced Computer Programming	5	A	20	INSY3072	Administration of Systems & Networks	5	B	15
INSY2021	Discrete Mathematics and Combinatory	5	A+	20	INSY3063	Object Oriented System Analysis and Design	5	B	15
Math 2231					INSY3083	Mobile Computing	5	A	20
						Semester Average: 3.67	30		110

Grading System: A+=x, A=x, A-=x, B+=x, B=x, B-=x, C+=x, C=x, C-=x, D=x, F=x, F+=x, FAIL=FAIL, NG=x, I=I, IA=x, PASS=PASS
Points :A+=4,A=4,A-=3.75,B+=3.5,B=3,B-=2.75,C+=2.5,C=2,C-=1.75,D=1,F=0,F+=0,FAIL=0,NG=0,I=0,IA=0,PASS=0

*Course Repeated,TR-Credit Transfer
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Date of Issue:

10 3 FEB 2025



Full Name : LYDIA FIKIRE SHIRGA
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Degree Awarded: BSc on July 4, 2024
Very Great Distinction

Course No	Course Title	ECTS	Grade	Gr. Point	Course No	Course Title	ECTS	Grade	Gr. Point
	Cumulative Average: 3.83	185		707.75					
	2023/24 Semester 1								
INSY4124	Internship*	4	A	16					
SNIE 1012	Inclusiveness	4	A-	15					
INSY4121	Industrial Project I	5	A	20					
INSY4091	Introduction to Artificial Intelligence	5	A*	20					
INSY4101	Information Systems Project Management	5	B+	17.5					
INSY4111	Human Computer Interaction	5	A	20					
INSY4123	Seminar in Information System	4	A-	15					
	Semester Average: 3.86	32		123.5					
	Cumulative Average: 3.83	217		831.25					
	2023/24 Semester 2								
INSY4102	Management of Information Systems and	5	B-	13.75					
INSY4093	Introduction to Data Science & Analytics	5	B	15					
GITr 1012	Global Trend	4	B	12					
INSY4122	Industrial Project II	5	A	20					
INSY4103	Enterprise Systems	5	A-	18.75					
INSY4092	Knowledge Management	5	B+	17.5					
Hist. 1012	History of Ethiopia and the Horn	5	B-	13.75					
	Semester Average: 3.26	34		110.75					
	Cumulative Average: 3.75	251		942					
	Major : 3.79								
	Date of Exit Exam: June, 2024								
	Exit Exam Result: 76.00%								

Student Copy

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